Saint Edward High School vs. St. Ignatius	2/6/2026	Prepared by: Coach Donelon

St. Ignatius enters our contest with an overall record of 11–6 and is 3–2 over their last five games, with blowout losses to Westerville North and Wasatch Academy during that stretch. Offensively, St. Ignatius is not running the same volume or variety of sets that they have in recent seasons. Instead, they rely heavily on Zoom action, middle ball screens, Loop (Iverson) cuts, and a heavy dose of isolation basketball. They want to play downhill, generate advantages one-on-one, and get out in transition, so our focus must be on floor balance and limiting them to one possession.

On the defensive end, St. Ignatius primarily plays man-to-man in the half court, but they have shown some 2-3 zone and occasional 1-3-1. They will also mix in 2-2-1 and 1-2-2 pressure, though the pressure is not as effective as in past years, as they do not rotate or recover out of it particularly well. We must handle pressure with composure, spacing, and decisiveness, play with pride, play with poise, and play with swagger — we are the better team, and we need to show them.

Favorite Sets	Last 2 Minute Sets/ Special Situations
LOOP - IVERSON CUT	BLOB - 1-4 LOW TO S+S
ZOOM ACTION	BLOB - BOX
MIDDLE BALL SCREEN	BLOB - BOX TO WEAKSIDE STAGGER
ISO ACTION	LOOP
SWIPE	ZOOM
PISTOL	ISO BALL

Offensive Tendencies	Defensive Tendencies
12. 9 FTA PER GAME	PRIMARILY WILL LOOK TO PLAY MAN TO MAN IN THE HALF COURT
68.5% FT SHOOTING	1-3-1 DEFENSE AND SOME 2-3 ZONE
35.6% 3PT SHOOTING TEAM	1-2-2 - WILL LOOK TO TRAP OVER HALF COURT
9.1 OFFENSIVE REBOUNDS PER GAME	POST DEFENSE: SLIP FRONT AND PLAY BEHIND
	WEAK SIDE ACTION - LOCK AND TRAIL
	HAVE SHOWN SOME TRAPPING OVER HALF
	HAVE SWITCHED ON WING

Strengths	Weaknesses
SIZE	ISO BALL
ABILITY TO SCORE	BENCH PRODUCTION
TRANSITION OFFENSE	HALF COURT DEFENSE - ROTATIONS
ABILITY TO SCORE OFF TURNOVERS	ZONE OFFENSE
GUARD PLAY	
CAN GET HOT FROM OUTSIDE	

LAST FIVE GAMES

Date	Opponent	Score	Leading Scorer	Leading Rebounds	Leading Assists
1/31	Westerville North	77 - 59 L	#4 - 16 points	#4 - 6 rebs	#2/25 - 3 assists
1/30	Canton McKinley	71 - 60 W	#2 - 27 points	#35 - 10 rebs	#4 - 6 assists
1/27	Louisville	83 - 64 W	#25 - 12 points	#35 - 11 rebs	#11 - 5 assists
1/23	Lutheran West	60 - 54 W	#5 - 19 points	#5 - 4 rebs	#11 - 4 assists
1/17	Wasatch Academy	74 - 37 L			

Keys To Victory		
	TRANSITION DEFENSE	WEAK SIDE ROTATIONS
	CONTROL THE GLASS	CONTEST OUTSIDES SHOOTERS
	NO STRAIGHT LINE DRIVES/MIDDLE	PLAY WITH HIGH ENERGY AND SWAG

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#25	#11 - #3 - #2 - #35

STARTERS

RIGHTY			JUNIOR	5.8 PPG	HIGH VOLUME 3PT	
#11 Sami Dari	6'2			81% FT	CONTEST OUTSIDE SHOTS - KEEP HIM IN FRONT	

Sami serves as the backup point guard and provides a steady offensive presence when he enters the game. He has strong ball-handling ability but can fall into periods of over-dribbling, which can lead to careless turnovers when pressured. Offensively, he has the ability to drive both left and right, though he is most comfortable attacking to his right, where he often looks to score with a floater around the rim. He has become a reliable perimeter shooter, with 50% of his field goal attempts coming from three-point range, where he is shooting 50% from beyond the arc. He is also active around the ball and is averaging 1.5 rebounds per game.

Defensively, it is important that we keep him in front, eliminate paint touches, and contest every perimeter look. We cannot allow him to get comfortable or find a rhythm from the outside, as he becomes more effective offensively when he is able to knock down open threes or turn the corner to get into the lane.

RIGHTY			SENIOR	12.5 PPG	HIGH VOLUME 3PT	
#3 Alex Mack	6'3			84.6% FT	CONTEST HIS SHOTS - FORCE HIM LEFT	

Alex is a high-volume three-point shooter, with 67.8% of his field-goal attempts coming from beyond the arc, where he is shooting 41.2% from three-point range on the season. He is a sneaky athletic guard who is very effective playing without the ball, consistently cutting hard to the rim and crashing the glass to generate extra possessions. With the ball, Alex can become turnover-prone when pressured, as he tends to over-dribble, particularly when attempting to create separation off the bounce. He prefers to operate with the ball in his right hand, looking to pull up for jump shots, but when forced to his left, his efficiency declines. On the right block, he is capable of scoring over defenders with a fade-away jumper. Overall, he is most effective scoring off the dribble, prefers to finish going right, and when driven left, he will often settle for pull-up jumpers, making it critical that we run him off the three-point line and force him left.

RIGHTY			SENIOR	13.8 PPG	DRIVE 1ST	
#2 RJ Jones	6'6			71.9% FT	NO PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP OFF GLASS	

RJ is a long, lanky, drive-first wing who plays with a high level of athleticism and has the ability to finish effectively with either hand. He is most comfortable attacking from the left wing, where he looks to exploit gaps using his explosive first step, though he is capable of driving in either direction. When attacking from the wing, he will spin back middle and is effective using spin moves to create space. He is also capable of spin-back finishes and will draw fouls when defenders are out of position.

RJ can get into a scoring rhythm but is not a consistent perimeter shooter, as 17.9% of his field-goal attempts have come from three-point range, where he is shooting 25% (6-for-24), primarily when left open in the corner. It is critical that we keep him out of the paint, speed him up, locate him early in transition, and keep him off the offensive glass. Defensively, RJ is an active on-ball defender who creates steals and deflections. However, he will spin blindly in traffic, making him vulnerable to offensive fouls and second-defender pressure when he puts the ball on the floor.

RIGHTY		SOPH	9.4 PPG	SCORER MENTALITY	
#25 Carlos Vaughn Jr.	6'5		47.1% FT	NO PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP OFF GLASS	

Carlos is an aggressive, drive-first guard with an explosive first step who consistently looks to attack off the catch. He does a good job of squaring up, using head fakes and jab steps before ripping downhill to create advantages. When he gets to the rim, he is capable of finishing with either his left or right hand, but he is most effective finishing with his right. While he is primarily a paint-touch scorer, much of his production comes from drive-and-dump opportunities and attacking gaps rather than pure isolation play. He is also active around the basket and is averaging 3.1 rebounds per game, contributing to second-chance opportunities.

Carlos has taken 25.8% of his field-goal attempts from three-point range, where he is shooting 45.8% from beyond the arc, making him a capable perimeter threat when left open. From memory, he will settle for early pull-up mid-range jumpers or early threes rather than consistently putting pressure on the rim. Defensively, we must keep him in front, eliminate paint touches, and keep him off the glass. He must be forced into pull-up jump shots and contested finishes, as he is far less effective when he is unable to get downhill or score off second-chance opportunities.

RIGHTY		SENIOR	4.1 PPG	OFF GLASS - P+R - 3PT	
#35 Keith Seide	6'8		75% FT	WALL UP - KEEP OFF GLASS	

Keith is a primary post presence for them and plays as a slow-footed big. In pick-and-roll action, he will roll hard to the basket, looking to score on rolls, drive-and-dump opportunities, and quick finishes around the rim. From the left wing, he prefers to attack the middle, while on the right block he looks to attack baseline. On the left block, he is more likely to face up and attack middle. He is extremely active around the basket and is averaging 5.8 rebounds per game, generating put-backs and second-chance opportunities, which makes him a key factor in extended possessions.

While primarily an interior scorer, he will stretch the floor at times, stepping out to the perimeter and shooting the three. On the season, 44% of his field-goal attempts have come from three-point range, where he is shooting 31.8% from beyond the arc, making it important that we are ready to close out and contest on the catch. Defensively, he must be kept off the glass, and we need to be physical with him early, forcing him to put the ball on the floor rather than allowing clean perimeter looks or easy finishes inside.

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#4 - #24	#5 - #22

STARTERS

RIGHTY			**SOPH**	6.9 PPG	**DRIVE 1ST GUARD**	
#4 Denahi Melton	**6'0**			60.7% FT	LIMIT PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP HIM IN FRONT	

Denahi is an explosive guard with strong ball-handling ability and court vision who consistently puts pressure on the defense. He can finish at the rim with either hand, score through contact, and uses a floater or euro step when navigating traffic. He moves well without the ball, cutting hard to the rim to find scoring opportunities, and is averaging 2.4 rebounds per game.

Offensively, 25.3% of his field-goal attempts have come from three-point range, where he is shooting 20%, making him more effective attacking downhill than settling from outside. Defensively, he is an aggressive on-ball defender who looks to disrupt, but can become undisciplined, gambling in passing lanes and losing his man on double actions when frustrated. When composed, he is capable of making the first escape pass against pressure.

LEFTY			**SENIOR**	5.4 PPG	**HIGH VOLUME 3PT**	
#5 Joe Maloof	**6'0**			72.7% FT	RUN HIM OFF LINE - FORCE HIM LEFT	

Joe has provided a spark off the bench with his energy and activity level. He does a good job of moving without the basketball, cutting hard to the rim, and will use a euro step to finish when he gets downhill. When driving right, he tends to settle for pull-up jump shots, while he prefers to drive left to finish at the rim. At times, his handle can get shaky, and he can be pressured into turnovers, particularly when defenders get into his body. He is active around the basket and is averaging 2.2 rebounds per game.

Joe is a high-volume three-point shooter, with 57% of his field-goal attempts coming from beyond the arc, where he is shooting 30.6% from three-point range. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the perimeter. Defensively, we must be prepared to run him off the three-point line, force him to put the ball on the floor, and make him drive right, where he is less effective.

RIGHTY			**FROSH**	0.7 PPG	**ROLE PLAYER**	
#24 Jordan Fortino	**6'1**			NO ATT	BE PHYSICAL - KEEP OUT OF PAINT	

Jordan is a freshman guard who has seen limited playing time and enters the game with very limited offensive production. Offensively, 33% of his field-goal attempts have come from three-point range, where he is 1-of-2 from beyond the arc on the season. When he puts the ball on the floor, he will look to pull up for a jump shot off the dribble and strictly prefers to drive to his right, rarely attacking left.

Defensively, we must be locked in on closeouts and prepared to run him off the three-point line, as his primary value comes from spot-up opportunities. He can be loose with the ball at times, so active hands and ball pressure are critical. When pressured, he can be forced into turnovers, especially when defenders speed him up.

RIGHTY	**SENIOR**	1.5 PPG	**OFF GLASS - DUMP OFFS**	
#22 Tristan Watkins		100% FT	KEEP OFF GLASS - WALL UP	

Tristan is a role player whose offensive production primarily comes from drive-and-dump opportunities and second-chance points. He needs to be around the rim to be effective. On the season, he is 0-for-2 from three-point range, making him a non-factor as a perimeter threat. When he is able to impact the game offensively, it is through energy plays, rim runs, and put-backs, where he looks to generate extra possessions. He is averaging 1.2 rebounds per game.

Defensively, Tristan does not move his feet well laterally and can be exploited by attacking him off the bounce. We can put pressure on him by driving the ball, which should allow us to draw fouls and potentially get him into foul trouble. The key is to keep him off the offensive glass and prevent him from becoming an X-factor through hustle plays, energy rebounds, and second-chance scoring.